



20 WAYS TVS COULD CHANGE 20 YEARS FROM NOW!

What is the future of content consumption? Have we seen stagnation in cutting edge TV technology, or is the best yet to come?

Sameer Mitha | feedback@digit.in

INTRODUCTION

The importance of the TV in your life has probably never been higher. With people spending more time at home the value of the idiot box has grown dramatically. But calling the TV an idiot box is so 1990s. In the past few years, the black mirror on your wall can stream content from the internet, let you control your smart home appliances and also tell you the status of your Amazon package. Not only has the technology powering TVs grown dramatically, but the ever-important question has pondered our mind, have we reached the pinnacle of TV technology?

HOW WE GOT HERE

20 years ago, TVs were fat, and CRT technology was king. When the colours went haywire, a technician would come home to “demagnetize” the TV. If you had a Sony WEGA 17-inch TV, you were considered to be cream of the crop! Yes, you heard that right, 17-inch TV was a big deal back in the late '90s and early 2000s.

But before the end of the decade, we started seeing flat screen TVs dominate the Indian market. Flat screen Plasma TVs were the premium offering with brands like Panasonic and LG offering them in India. The average consumer was enthralled

with a 24-inch or even 32-inch flat screen LED backlit TV with a resolution of 1366 x 768 and FHD TVs were the aspirational devices. Yes, by the late 2000s, FHD TVs had arrived and it was time for the TV to go on a diet.

By 2012, 4K resolution had kicked in and Sony and LG started flexing their resolution prowess. We also saw TVs go slimmer and it was not only a



CRT TV

battle for screen space in your living room but also an aesthetic appeal. This was also the time that TVs started implementing 3D tech and we saw a few curved TVs launch, but by the mid-2010s curved TVs and 3D TVs were a bust. It was time for the war of the colours - HDR.

While terms like HDR, Dolby Vision and Dolby Atmos may be a staple today, back in mid-2015, TV

manufacturers were beginning to tap into the potential of TV technology. It was only over the past 5-7 years that we have seen TVs push the envelope with colour gamut aspiring to hit the BT2020 standard, brightness to burn your retina and technology that's pushed to the limit. We also saw the emergence of Smart TVs letting you stream content from the internet,

control smart home appliances and consumers could finally talk to their TV.

But over the past year, TV technology has kinda stagnated. 8K TVs are around, but 8K content is nowhere on the horizon. HDMI 2.1 gives consumers the ability to push 120Hz in 4K on TVs and some new gaming consoles come with HDMI 2.1 support. However, the lingering question remains, have we seen the best that TVs have to offer, or is the best form of content consumption at home around the corner? Here is a look at 20 ways in which content consumption on the TV will change in 20 years.

1. A final nail in the coffin for Physical Media

When was the last time you went out and rented a DVD or Blu-ray? Sure, there are some purists who will argue that physical media has better performance when compared to streaming